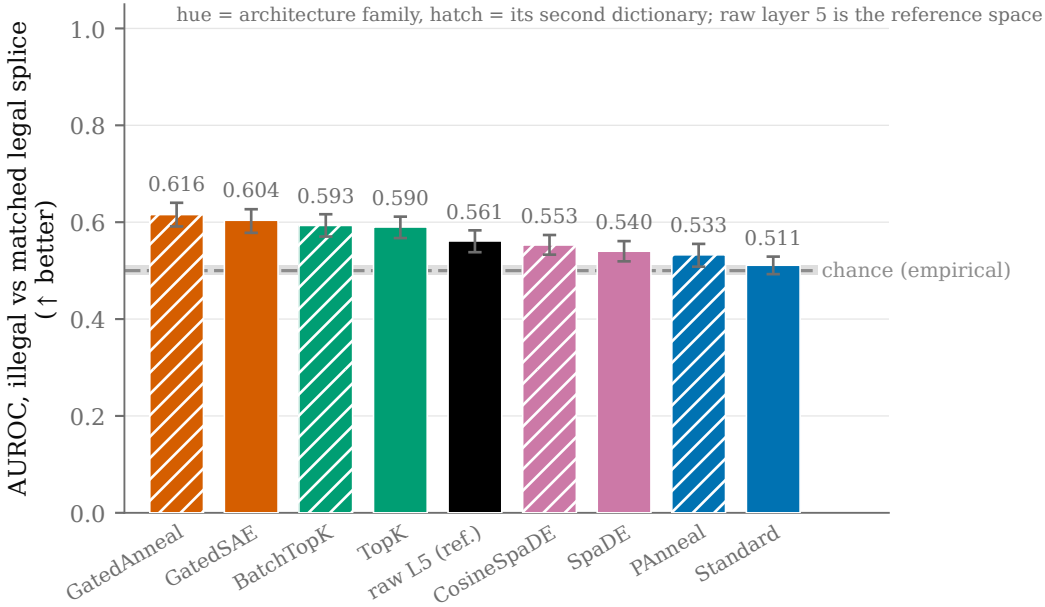

Score: how much shorter than usual the step through the space is, standardized per move index against legal games, then contrasted across each candidate move (MOSUM, m = 4 plies before and after) and scanned blind over the whole game -- no knowledge that a move was spliced, and no counterfactual branch. The window was chosen on the straightness violation corpus, whose splices differ. Bars are the AUROC of the illegal branch's peak against the same game's legal-splice branch, one illegal branch per game at seed 42; AUROCs are never flipped, so a bar at 0.5 is the finding. Whiskers are 95% percentile bootstrap CIs over 575 games (1,000 resamples); the 4 dictionaries above raw also clear it on the paired difference, which reuses the same resamples (+0.029 to +0.054, none spanning zero). The gray band is the empirical null: each game's legal control scored against the second legal control it carries.